AzurX

IAC ANTALYA 2026

POST-EVENT REPORT · OCTOBER 2026

aws

LAUNCH PAD

Building the Commercial and Technological Infrastructure for the Next Era of Space



6 OCTOBER 2026 BELEK, ANTALYA · IAC 2026 AWS × AZURX

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60+
Peak attendance

10
Speakers

9
Organisations on stage

8,400
LinkedIn impressions

PREPARED FOR
Dr. Salem El Nimri, Chief of Space Technology, AWS Aerospace & Satellite Solutions

CONVENED BY
AWS Aerospace & Satellite Solutions, in partnership with AzurX

DATE AND TIME
6 October 2026, 11:30 AM – 3:30 PM

LOCATION
Belek, Antalya, Türkiye · on the sidelines of IAC 2026

01

Executive overview

> *A high-level leadership forum held alongside the 77th International Astronautical Congress in Antalya, Türkiye.*

On 6 October 2026, AWS Aerospace & Satellite Solutions and AzurX convened LAUNCHPAD: Building the Commercial and Technological Infrastructure for the Next Era of Space, a high-level leadership forum held alongside the 77th International Astronautical Congress (IAC) in Antalya, Türkiye.

Bringing together senior government decision-makers, space agency leaders, commercial space executives and technology experts, LAUNCHPAD created a focused setting for candid discussion on two critical forces shaping the future of the space sector: the evolution of government–commercial partnerships and the emergence of AI as foundational infrastructure for space operations.

The event reached a peak attendance of over 60 participants and featured an exceptional international speaker line-up spanning NASA, NOAA, the Norwegian Space Agency, the German Space Agency (DLR), JPL, the Mohammed Bin Rashid Space Centre (MBRSC), Axiom Space, VAST, Balerion Space Ventures and leading space technology and investment organisations.

For AWS, LAUNCHPAD provided an opportunity to demonstrate its role not simply as a technology provider, but as a strategic partner in shaping the commercial, technological and institutional foundations of the next era of space. The programme connected policy and procurement considerations with practical questions around cloud infrastructure, AI, mission autonomy, data exploitation and sustainable commercial growth.

The event also established a platform for continued engagement beyond IAC, with an accompanying speakers' dinner that evening providing a further opportunity for relationship-building among senior participants.



THE ROOM

Over 60 participants at peak, at Susesi Convention Center, Belek.

02

Attendance and audience

> *A highly relevant, internationally diverse audience, with over 60 people in attendance at its peak.*

The gathering brought together representatives from government space agencies, civil space programmes, commercial space companies, investment funds, emerging infrastructure providers and the wider space ecosystem.

The quality and seniority of the speaker line-up were particular strengths. Participants heard directly from leaders responsible for space policy, national programmes, Earth observation, commercial space infrastructure, AI research and future human spaceflight.

The combination of public-sector authority, technical expertise and commercial leadership gave the event a distinctive cross-sector character, with exceptional breadth and senior-level representation despite IAC-related logistical constraints that affected attendance.

ORGANISATIONS ON STAGE

NASA · NOAA · NASA JPL · Norwegian Space Agency · DLR · MBRSC · Axiom Space · VAST · Balerion Space Ventures



Networking among participants

THE PROGRAMME

Four sessions, one stage

01 Opening remarks

Master of Ceremonies Amandeep Bhangu, award-winning presenter and former BBC News reporter, opened the event and welcomed the event Host, Salem El Nimri, AWS Chief of Space Technology.

02 Fireside chat

Salem El Nimri, AWS Chief of Space Technology, in conversation with Adnan AlRais, Assistant Director General for Space Operations & Exploration, MBRSC.

03 Panel 1 · From Buyer to Market-Maker

Moderated by Tyler Hardy, AWS

Christian Hauglie-Hanssen	Norwegian Space Agency
Taylor Jordan	NOAA
René Kleeßen	DLR / German Space Agency
Giorgio Saccoccia	VAST

04 Panel 2 · AI Applications in Space

Moderated by Dev Jodhun, AWS

A.C. Charania	Balerion Space Ventures
Dr. Steve Chien	NASA JPL
Irene Parker	NOAA NESDIS
Jared Stout	Axiom Space
Dr. Karen St. Germain	NASA



Panel 2 on stage

03

Programme and discussion highlights



Panel 1 · From Buyer to Market-Maker

Government as a market-maker

The first panel explored how governments can move beyond traditional procurement to stimulate sustainable commercial space markets. Discussion centred on long-term demand signals, innovative contracting and partnership models, shared infrastructure, commercial ground systems, hosted payloads and the balance between commercial adoption, security, sovereignty and resilience. The conversation reinforced the importance of governments creating the conditions for private investment and innovation to scale.

AI as foundational space infrastructure

The second panel examined how AI, cloud computing and increasingly autonomous systems can transform mission operations and support a sustained human and robotic presence across low Earth orbit, the Moon and beyond. Perspectives from NASA, NOAA and commercial operators highlighted the growing importance of turning vast volumes of space and Earth observation data into actionable insight, while maintaining appropriate security, resilience and human oversight.



Fireside chat · Salem El Nimri and Adnan AlRais

Strategic dialogue and international cooperation

The opening fireside chat between Salem El Nimri and Adnan AlRais connected the broader industry discussion to the operational realities of developing and sustaining national space capabilities. Across the programme, a consistent theme emerged: the future of space will depend not only on what can be built and launched, but also on the infrastructure, partnerships and enabling conditions that allow capabilities to scale.

Together, the sessions positioned LAUNCHPAD as a forum for substantive discussion at the intersection of policy, technology and commercial opportunity.

04

Engagement and opportunities

> *A concentrated environment for AWS to engage directly with senior stakeholders across the international space ecosystem.*

Its value lay in bringing together decision-makers who influence government priorities, commercial infrastructure requirements, technology adoption and future space investment. The discussions provided a foundation for follow-on engagement in several areas:

01

Government and agency modernisation

Cloud-enabled mission operations, ground infrastructure, data platforms and scalable computing.

02

AI and autonomous operations

Applications in Earth observation, mission planning, space science, situational awareness and sustained exploration.

03

Commercial infrastructure and partnerships

Opportunities to support the transition towards commercially delivered space capabilities and service-based models.

04

International ecosystem development

Stronger connections between agencies, established operators, emerging commercial providers and strategic partners.



SPEAKERS' DINNER

A speakers' dinner held on the evening of 6 October extended the opportunity for more informal senior-level engagement and relationship development beyond the main programme.

THE NEXT PHASE

The next phase should focus on translating these connections into documented follow-up conversations, customer discovery, partnership discussions and qualified opportunities. Specific commercial outcomes should be assessed through post-event engagement tracking.

05

Communications and visibility

> *A strong collection of senior voices and timely themes, and a compelling platform for AWS thought leadership in aerospace and satellite solutions.*

Dedicated WhatsApp channels enabled timely updates, rapid responses and seamless coordination. Moderators were connected with their panellists ahead of time, supported by three speaker catch-up calls to align on content and ensure thorough preparation. These efforts fostered a strong sense of community among the 10 speakers and their teams.

The event's communications potential extended beyond AWS-owned channels to the professional networks of Master of Ceremonies Amandeep Bhangu, panel moderators Tyler Hardy and Dev Jodhun, participating speakers and co-host AzurX.

The strongest communications narrative is AWS's role in convening government and industry leaders to explore how commercial partnerships, cloud infrastructure and AI will enable the next era of space.

The event photography and a central post-event landing page were created to provide a lasting record of the programme and support subsequent stakeholder outreach, internal communications and future LAUNCHPAD promotion.

LINKEDIN REACH · FIVE POSTS

8,400

impressions

133
Reactions

17
Comments

6
Reposts

IMPRESSIONS BY POST



Figures as of 19 October 2026. Full post details in Appendix C.

06

Feedback and lessons

> *A focused, invitation-led convening alongside a major international congress enabled substantive discussion among senior participants without competing with the broader scale of IAC.*

STRENGTH

Audience quality over volume

The 60-person peak attendance provided an appropriately focused setting for senior-level dialogue.

STRENGTH

Cross-sector programming

Combining government, agency, commercial and technical perspectives strengthened the relevance of both panels.

STRENGTH

Positive initial feedback

Feedback received from participants, speakers and their teams has been consistently positive.

FOR REVIEW

IAC logistics

Future editions should build in additional contingency for travel, scheduling conflicts and last-minute cancellations.

FOR REVIEW

Outcome measurement

A structured post-event process is needed to capture participant feedback, introductions, follow-up meetings and resulting opportunities.

FOR REVIEW

Ongoing feedback

Formal participant feedback and quantified communications metrics should be incorporated as they become available.

07

Recommended next steps

01 Activate priority relationships

Identify priority speakers and participants for personalised follow-up, with clear AWS relationship owners and proposed next actions.

02 Convert dialogue into opportunities

Develop a short opportunity tracker covering agency modernisation, AI and autonomy, commercial infrastructure and strategic partnerships.

03 Amplify the event's visibility

Publish or consolidate event highlights, approved photographs, speaker contributions and social posts from AWS, AzurX, the MC and moderators.

04 Complete the event record

Include the event archive, containing the programme and speaker line-up, in the central landing page alongside the approved photography.

05 Capture outcomes and plan the next edition

Collect participant feedback, document follow-up meetings and review lessons learned to inform a future LAUNCHPAD convening.

06 Future editions

Build on the success of this inaugural edition by hosting at least one LAUNCHPAD event annually in priority markets, targeting strategic customer groups and sustaining momentum through continued engagement.



OVERALL ASSESSMENT

LAUNCHPAD successfully brought together a high-calibre group of international space leaders for a focused discussion on the commercial and technological foundations of the next era of space. For AWS Aerospace & Satellite Solutions, it provided a valuable platform for thought leadership, senior stakeholder engagement and the development of relationships that can be advanced into tangible opportunities.

08

Supporting appendices

APPENDIX A

Event landing page and photography catalogue



Scan to open the photo gallery

Public link, no sign-in required. Every photograph can be viewed full size and downloaded.

f7g7v6kn5r-lab.github.io/AzurX/launchpad ↗

25	67	50	13	109	264
Fireside Chat	Panel 1	Panel 2	Closing Remarks	General	Total

APPENDIX B

Event in pictures



The audience



Fireside chat


Panel 1


Panel 2


Networking in the foyer



Registration


Closing remarks


Speakers, hosts and organisers

APPENDIX B

Hosts and speaker line-up



Hosts and moderators

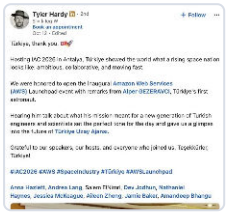


Speakers

Presented by Master of Ceremonies Amandeep Bhangu, co-hosts Dr. Salem El Nimri of AWS Aerospace & Satellite and Anna Hazlett of AzurX, and moderators Tyler Hardy and Dev Jodhun of AWS, with ten speakers from NASA, NOAA, NASA JPL, the Norwegian Space Agency, the German Space Agency (DLR), MBRSC, VAST, Axiom Space and Balerion Space Ventures.

APPENDIX C

Social media evidence

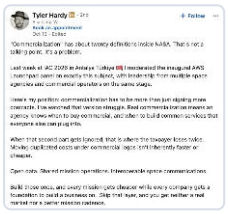


Tyler Hardy

12 Oct 2026

Thank-you post on opening the inaugural AWS LAUNCHPAD

IMPR.	REACT.	COMM.	REPOST
2,642	46	3	1

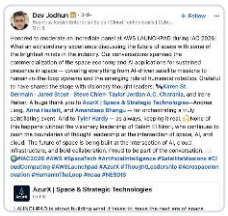


Tyler Hardy

13 Oct 2026

Reflection on Panel 1: what commercialisation should mean for space agencies

IMPR.	REACT.	COMM.	REPOST
2,879	42	11	0



Dev Jodhun

8 Oct 2026

Reflection on Panel 2: AI applications for a sustained presence in space

IMPR.	REACT.	COMM.	REPOST
862	13	2	0



AzurX

8 Oct 2026

Post-event announcement with the speaker line-up

IMPR.	REACT.	COMM.	REPOST
1,663	27	1	4



Space Agenda

25 Sep 2026

Pre-event listing and registration call

IMPR.	REACT.	COMM.	REPOST
354	5	0	1

Reactions, comments and reposts are public counts recorded on 19 October 2026. Impressions are taken from each author's post analytics, as provided on 19 October 2026. Tap a post to open it on LinkedIn.

APPENDIX D

Outcomes dashboard

PRIORITY FOLLOW-UPS

To be confirmed

Speakers and participants selected for personalised follow-up

As of: —

MEETINGS AGREED

To be confirmed

Follow-up meetings confirmed with stakeholders

As of: —

QUALIFIED OPPORTUNITIES

To be confirmed

Opportunities logged in the tracker

As of: —

FEEDBACK RECEIVED

To be confirmed

Formal responses from participants and speakers

As of: —

STAKEHOLDER	ORGANISATION	AWS OWNER	NEXT ACTION	STATUS
—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—
—	—	—	—	—

Outcome figures are recorded only once confirmed by the AWS relationship owners. Tracker entries remain confidential to AWS.



THANK YOU

To every speaker, moderator, host and participant who made the inaugural AWS LAUNCHPAD possible.

AWS LAUNCHPAD 2026
Post-Event Report

IN PARTNERSHIP WITH

AzurX

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